

Parent/Family/Legal Guardian Expectations

The program will expect engaged and on-going parent/family/legal guardian adherence to IES' philosophy of facilitating an opportunity for the student to have an independent college experience. Parent/family/legal guardian responsibilities include:

- Balancing the need to support and guide the student where appropriate with the necessity of letting the student make choices, explore opportunities, experience success, and encounter failure (significant and over-burdening parental/family/legal guardian involvement may provide short-term victories but mitigates long-term success);
- Securing funding for the student's participation (academic courses, related academic expenses, housing, meals, daily living needs, etc.), which may include support from the Florida Center for Students with Unique Abilities, Vocational Rehabilitation, other scholarships, and personal resources.
- Supporting students with transportation to off-campus internships.
- Supporting student independence and allowing students opportunities to actively participate in situation management with the support of the IES staff as needed; achieving this responsibility includes not contacting UCF professors, UCF work and volunteer supervisors, or other UCF campus department staff on behalf of a student. Failure to meet these guidelines can result in termination of student's academic, work, or campus experience.
- Acknowledging that an IES student is held to the same standards and consequences for conduct as any UCF student.
- Acknowledging that IES retains the right to make administrative judgment decisions that will include not contacting parents/family/legal guardians regarding most day-to-day decisions and that may include administratively removing a student from housing (with the option to continue to participate in IES as a commuter student), suspending a student from IES for a period of time, or permanently removing a student from IES.
- Participating in all required meetings asked of the IES staff.
- Conducting all communication with IES/UCF staff in a professional and civil manner.

Family Communication

IES and UCF staff engage with the students first and foremost. The students are the ones who are expected to make decisions about what classes to take, what jobs to pursue, what campus activities to explore, and what social experiences to participate in, based on personal preferences. All students affiliated with IES 24 are also connected with Student Accessibility Services (SAS). For any student connected with SAS, the students are given a Communication and Consent document through which the student may sign off on permission for IES and SAS staff to communicate with parents as necessary. Even when this consent is signed by a student, IES and SAS first work with the student. Administrative judgment is utilized to determine when to contact parents regarding day-to-day student matters. To further clarify, administrative judgment is utilized as follows for these primary areas of the student college experience:

Academic and Vocational: IES staff will work with students in making final decisions on academic courses for a given semester and prior to a student interviewing for and securing a campus job, campus volunteer experience, or a community job or internship experience. Parents and family supports are encouraged to be actively involved in these conversations with students and may contact IES staff with insight and questions pertaining to this process. However, IES staff will not automatically contact parents and family supports prior to final decisions in these areas. Furthermore, parents and family supports will not be notified about specific day-to-day activity within a class or a job, such as a student skipping a class, oversleeping for an exam, or missing a

work shift. IES staff will exercise administrative judgment as to when such day-to-day instances warrant parent and family notification.

Medical: Students who choose to use Student Health Services (SHS) may do so on their own terms. IES staff may accompany the student for the first visit to assist with any paperwork or other logistics. At select times, per student consent, IES staff may participate in a treatment visit with appropriate authorization in the SHS system. In the rare event that the student experiences other medical services on campus (such as an ambulance visit or other emergency care), IES or appropriate UCF staff will not necessarily contact parents and family prior to or after the rendering of service. IES or UCF staff will work with the student to determine if/how parents should be notified but may also choose to contact parents per administrative judgment.

Counseling: Students who choose to use Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS) or the Community Counseling and Research Center may do so on their own terms. IES staff may accompany the student for the first visit to assist with any paperwork or other logistics. At very select times, per student consent, IES staff may participate in a counseling visit with appropriate authorization.

Document Completion: Documents that require student signature, such as Housing Contracts or certain forms to be completed on occasion within the Registrar's Office, Academic Services, etc. will not be monitored by IES staff. Students are encouraged to notify parents and family when such action is needed.

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Social and Campus Life Activity: As part of the immersive and inclusive experience, informal and occasionally formal social and campus life activity without IES staff and UCF personnel supervision constitutes a significant portion of the student's UCF experience. Therefore, it is essential that students have the opportunity to be freely involved in these social activities in accordance with our philosophy. Students are free to participate based on personal preferences.